

01 SMALL TALK

Do you collect points or stamps at your favorite café?

How many apps are on your phone right now — just a few, or way too many?

Do you usually use your coupons before they expire, or forget about them?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

① ~~"The price is too expensive."~~
✓ "It's too expensive. / The price is too high."
'expensive'는 물건에, 'price'에는 'high/low'를 써요.

② ~~"I want to save my money for future."~~
✓ "I want to save up for the future."
'my'는 빼고 'the future'로, 'save up'이 더 자연스러워요.

③ ~~"I spend money to shopping."~~
✓ "I spend money on shopping."
'spend money on + 명사/-ing'가 고정 패턴이에요.

03 오늘의 워업

앞은 자리에서 손가락으로 A(1) 또는 B(2) 표시. 한 라운드마다 한 명 짧게 이유 한 문장. 5분 안에 끝.

WARM-UP

This or That · 빠른 5라운드

① Stack points everywhere VS Stick to one brand

② Chase the next tier VS Ignore the tier

③ Buy more to use a coupon VS Let the coupon expire

④ Pay with points now VS Save points for later

⑤ Paid membership (Costco, Coupang) VS Free points card only

MONEY · MAIN DISCUSSION

Membership Points — Smart Savings or Another Trap?

BACKGROUND

포인트 적립이나 멤버십은 돈을 아끼는 방법처럼 보이지만, 동시에 소비 습관을 바꾸는 장치가 되기도 해요. 몇 번만 가면 본전이라는 생각 때문에 원래 안 갔을 브랜드를 더 자주 찾게 될 수 있고, 등급이나 쿠폰을 놓치기 싫어서 결제 기준이 흔들릴 수도 있어요. 진짜 절약인지, 브랜드에 묶이는 방식인지는 그 멤버십이 없어도 똑같이 선택했을지 생각해보면 더 분명해져요.

READ BEFORE WE TALK

Membership points make spending feel smarter, because every purchase seems to give something back. The problem is that the reward can quietly guide your next purchase. A café stamp, a delivery benefit, or a point event may make someone choose the same brand more often than they planned. Sometimes that is genuinely useful, because the brand already fits their routine. Other times, the program creates a habit that only looks like saving. The real question is simple: does the membership serve your lifestyle, or slowly train your lifestyle around the membership?

WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

the points add up — 포인트가 쌓이다

break even — 본전 뽑다

it's not worth it — 그럴 가치가 없어

a rip-off — 완전 바가지

a steal — 완전 득템

on a tight budget — 돈이 빠듯해

TRY THESE PHRASES

*I'd say points help me spend smarter because ____.**Honestly, it goes both ways — ____, but ____.**In my case, yes — I once ____ just to keep a benefit.**Looking back, that purchase taught me ____.*

EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'sign-up-for-every-membership' or a 'just-a-few-favorites' person?
- 2 When was the last time you checked how many points you'd actually saved up?
- 3 Quick — if you had to pick: paper stamp card, app points, or a plastic membership card — which do you use most?
- 4 On a scale of 1 to 5, how often do you scan your membership barcode at checkout?

MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. Do membership points make you spend smarter, or just spend more often?

*I'd say points help me spend smarter because ____.**Honestly, it goes both ways — ____, but ____.*

Q2. Have you ever bought something just to keep a coupon, tier, or benefit? How did it feel?

*In my case, yes — I once ____ just to keep a benefit.**Looking back, that purchase taught me ____.*

Q3. At what price does a membership stop feeling worth it for you?

*It really comes down to how often I use it — ____.**For something I open every day, I'd pay up to ____.*

Q4. Would you pay a little more at a brand just to collect points? Why or why not?

*I lean more toward staying with one brand because ____.**It depends on the price gap, but usually ____.*

Q5. Which membership would you cancel if you were honest with yourself, and why is it hard to cancel?

*If I'm being honest, the one I should cancel is ____.**The hard part is ____ — that's why I keep paying.*